

Daily Economic Briefing

Macro, equities, commodities & derivatives — for Alex
Edition 17 · Thursday 10 September 2026 (Asia/Phnom_Penh) · Window: Tue 8 Sept – Wed 9 Sept 2026, research cutoff approx. 20:08 ET Wed 9 Sept / 00:08 UTC 10 Sept

Assumptions, corrections & scheduler status

- Scheduler healthy:** single fire at 2026-09-10T00:08:10Z, approx. 8 min after the 00:00 UTC slot, no duplicate, no gap.
- Two-session window:** edition 16 (Mon 7 Sept, Labor Day) previewed but did not cover Tuesday's reopen. This edition covers both Tuesday 8 Sept and Wednesday 9 Sept; Wednesday (most recent) carries full depth, Tuesday is condensed per the standing catch-up convention.
- Fed Chair Kevin Warsh** re-verified fresh via federalreserve.gov's Board of Governors bio and leadership roster — unchanged; Powell remains a Governor only.^[28,29]
- Copper ATH revised:** a fresh Comex intraday record of approx. \$6.85–6.87/lb was set 8 Sept 2026 (TASS, Yahoo Finance), superseding the previously reported 25 Aug record of \$6.7270/lb.^[51,52,53]
- Canada tariff figure:** official Canadian product list and CNBC/Blakes corroborate C\$27.6bn; NPR, Al Jazeera and Fortune instead cited \$20bn — using \$27.6bn as the better-sourced figure and disclosing the gap.^[33,34,35,36,37]
- Snapshot-vs-close corrections applied on verification:** GME's Tuesday close resolved to \$18.89 (–1.41%), not a \$19.37 mid-day snapshot some outlets carried; AAPL's Wednesday close resolved to \$315.34 (–0.28%), not a –1.30% pre-close snapshot; VIX's Wednesday close resolved to approx. 16.44–16.46 (+4.6%), not a stale –apparent-decline row on one aggregator.
- Trigger prompt still unchanged** (retired GitHub/Telegram delivery language), 11th edition running since edition 6 — continuing to hold per the standing edition-9 judgment call; this was an unattended fire, so not re-escalating.

60-second read

- Iran-Hormuz war escalated sharply: US forces destroyed five Iranian tankers Wednesday; Iran struck roughly ten ships in the Strait and fired on a US base in Jordan. Brent topped \$100/bbl for the first time since July, but VIX rose a contained +4.6% to approx. 16.44 — the market pricing risk, not panic.^[39,47,48,59,60]
- Two-day risk-off broadened: S&P 500 –0.6% Tue, –0.5% Wed (–1.1% cumulative); Tuesday's dip was concentrated in Healthcare and Financials, Wednesday's hit nine of eleven sectors with only Energy positive.^[1,2,3]
- Apple's first product event under new CEO John Ternus (foldable iPhone Duo, \$1,999; iPhone 18 Pro +\$100) drew a shrug, –0.28% — rich valuation and margin-pressure concerns capped any pop. Meta's "Muse" AI-agent launch was the bigger mover, +6.55%.^[8,9,10,12,13]
- Canada's C\$27.6bn retaliatory tariffs took effect Tuesday; Washington counter-retaliated with a Sept 29 ban on Canadian alcohol, dairy and motorcycles — trade war still escalating, though USD/CAD barely moved.^[33,36,37,38]
- Day ahead is the pivot: PPI and Oracle's earnings (implied ±11.2% move) land Thursday; Friday's CPI is now seen as the decisive input for the 16 Sept FOMC decision, more than early September's payrolls beat.^[41,42,45,46]

1. Market recap

S&P 500 (Wed) 7,636.36 –0.5% · Tue –0.6%	Dow (Wed) 52,380.66 –0.8% · Tue –1.2%	Nasdaq (Wed) 26,253.34 –0.6% · Tue –0.3%	Russell 2000 (Wed) 2,921.23 –1.3% · Tue –0.5%	VIX (Wed) 16.44 +4.6% · vs 15.72
---	--	---	--	---

Both sessions of the holiday-shortened week closed lower as the Hormuz tanker war intensified.^[1,2] Tuesday: S&P 500 –0.6% to 7,673.52, Dow –1.2% to 52,786.07, Nasdaq –0.3% to 26,421.41, Russell 2000 –0.5% to 2,960.20. Wednesday: S&P –0.5% to 7,636.36, Dow –0.8% to 52,380.66, Nasdaq –0.6% to 26,253.34, Russell –1.3% to 2,921.23.^[1,2] Breadth worsened materially session over session: Tuesday's decline was concentrated in Healthcare (–2.52%) and Financials (–1.38%) after Novartis disclosed two failed drug trials (cardiovascular, muscular dystrophy) that weighed on healthcare peers broadly, while Energy (+1.11%) and Tech (+0.32%) held up on the weekend's tanker strikes.^[3,5] Wednesday's was broad-based, with only Energy (+0.83%) positive across the eleven SPDR sectors and roughly 70–78% of issues lower.^[3,4,7] VIX rose from 15.72 to approx. 16.44–16.46 (+4.6%), with VVIX (+6.6%) and VIX9D (+5.9%) moving harder than the headline gauge — near-dated hedging demand outrunning realized volatility.^[59,60]

2. Equities and earnings

Wednesday 9 September — full session

Apple unveiled its first products under new CEO John Ternus at a "Surprise and Shine" event: the **iPhone Duo**, its first foldable iPhone (\$1,999), and the **iPhone 18 Pro** with a new 2nm chip carrying a \$100 price increase over the prior generation, plus updated Siri/AI features, new AirPods and Watch models.^[8,9] The stock closed –0.28% to \$315.34^[10,11] — a muted reaction consistent with KeyBanc's (Underweight, \$250 PT) pre-event note that AAPL has averaged just –0.72% on launch day over the past five years, and with a forward P/E (approx. 36x) sitting well above its three-year average (approx. 30x), leaving little room to re-rate on a hardware refresh alone.^[62]

Meta was the session's standout, +6.55% to \$653.69 (volume 98% above the three-month average) on the launch of "Muse," an autonomous personal AI agent for shopping, travel booking and calendar tasks with tiered consumer subscription pricing; Morgan Stanley sized the addressable AI-agent market at approx. \$30 trillion, and a youth-safety litigation settlement removed a legal overhang.^[12,13] Peers were mixed: Alphabet fell 2.3–2.8% (sources disagree on the exact figure) and Snap fell 2.2%.^[7,13] **Marvell** rose 4.3% to \$235.01 after positioning itself as "the Switzerland of AI" — infrastructure spanning hyperscalers rather than tied to one — on renewed AI-capex demand commentary.^[14,15]

Two names fell on idiosyncratic news: **Booking Holdings** dropped 3.8% to \$173.43 (a second straight down day, –6.7% Tuesday) after the EU General Court upheld the European Commission's block of its €1.63bn eTraveli acquisition;^[21,22] and **UnitedHealth** fell 1.9% to \$393.06 on conference commentary flagging persistent medical-utilization trends, a longer timeline to normalize commercial margins, and a stake sale in its Florida Optum Health clinics.^[25] Wells Fargo downgraded building-products names Eagle Materials, Vulcan Materials and Amrize (EXP, VMC, AMRZ) on a more cautious 2027 outlook (single-sourced).^[6]

Company	Report	Revenue (act./est.)	EPS (act./est.)	Reaction
GameStop (GME)	Q2 FY26, Tue AH	\$790.2M / \$756.9M	\$0.27 / \$0.27	–1.4% Tue (pre-print) → +4.7% Wed ^[16,17,18]
Casey's Gen. Stores (CASY)	Q1 FY27	\$5.68B / \$5.57B	\$7.37 / \$6.72	–14.2% Wed — inside-sales miss despite headline beat ^[23,24]
Signet Jewelers (SIG)	Q2	beat, guidance raised	beat	+24.0% Wed ^[6]

Tuesday 8 September — condensed (first session back from the long weekend)

GameStop closed –1.4% to \$18.89 ahead of its post-close Q2 print (collectibles revenue +57% y/y to \$356.3M, 45% of sales; FY guide raised to "in excess of \$650M" adjusted EBITDA; a director disclosed a approx. \$1.03M insider purchase the same week).^[16,17,19,20] Canada's tariffs took effect at 12:01am with a mixed equity read-through among named names — Nucor –1.8%, Deere –1.9%, but Alcoa +3.5% [Section 3]; sector performance split along the Novartis-driven healthcare hit and a modest Energy/Tech bid as oil climbed on the weekend's tanker strikes.^[3,5] Notable analyst actions: Synopsys upgraded to Overweight at Morgan Stanley (\$500 PT); Palo Alto Networks cut to Neutral at Phillip Securities; Lockheed Martin upgraded to Buy at UBS (\$674 PT); Best Buy cut to Neutral at DA Davidson.^[26,27]

Single-stock movers, Tue 8 – Wed 9 Sept 2026

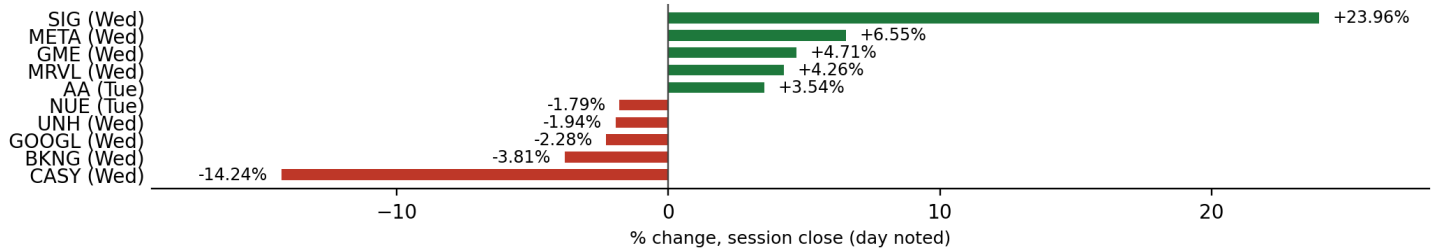


Chart 1 — Single-stock movers, session close (day noted), Tue 8 – Wed 9 Sept 2026.^[3,6,7,10,12,14,16,21,23]

3. Macro, policy and rates

Fed Chair Kevin Warsh was re-verified fresh via the Federal Reserve's own Board of Governors biography and leadership roster pages — unchanged; Jerome Powell remains a Governor only.^[28,29] The September FOMC meeting is confirmed for 15–16 Sept, with the blackout period running 5–17 Sept; the only Fed remarks this window were Governor Waller's 3 Sept Reuters NEXT interview (pre-blackout), which signaled support for holding rates steady.^[30,31,32]

The US–Canada trade war escalated further. Canada's C\$27.6bn in retaliatory tariffs (steel, aluminum, dairy, electronics and roughly 700 other product lines, tiered 15/25/50%) took effect Tuesday at 12:01am ET;^[33,34,35] some outlets (NPR, Al Jazeera, Fortune) instead cited \$20bn — we use the official Canadian finance-ministry product list, corroborated by CNBC and Blakes, and disclose the gap.^[36,37] Washington counter-retaliated, announcing a ban on imports of most Canadian alcohol, select dairy, some motorcycles/mopeds and molasses effective 29 Sept, and directing the GSA to strip Canadian products from federal procurement. Canadian PM Mark Carney: "You're at war when you get attacked. We got attacked."^[36,37] USD/CAD's reaction was muted (1.378–1.3785 across both sessions) — oil-driven CAD strength offset tariff pressure.^[38]

Iran's Hormuz Strait war intensified sharply Wednesday: US Central Command destroyed five Iranian oil tankers overnight; Iran retaliated with strikes on roughly ten ships in the Strait and ballistic missiles targeting a US base in Jordan, and its IRGC declared a maritime "restricted zone." Strait tanker traffic has fallen to roughly 10 vessels/day, down from approx. 100/day before the conflict.^[39,40]

4. Commodities and FX

Oil surged on the Hormuz escalation across both sessions; the fast-moving tape means no single settlement print could be confirmed, so we report ranges and disclose this in Annex A. Brent moved from roughly \$98–99/bbl Tuesday to briefly above \$100/bbl Wednesday (first time since July); WTI moved from the mid-\$90s to roughly \$95–97.^[47,48] Gold rose from \$4,355.80 to \$4,404.84 (+1.1%) and silver from \$65.75 to \$67.16 (+2.1%) on dollar softness and positioning ahead of Friday's CPI.^[49,50] Copper set a fresh Comex intraday all-time high around \$6.85–6.87/lb Tuesday 8 Sept — superseding the previously reported 25 Aug record of \$6.7270/lb — before settling Wednesday at \$6.7743/lb (+0.52%).^[51,52,53]

The dollar index (DXY) held roughly flat to modestly softer near 98.7–98.8, touching a two-week low intraday Wednesday.^[54,55] USD/CAD was little moved by the tariff implementation ("Canadian Dollar shrugs off new tariffs").^[56] The yen was the strongest G10 currency, with USD/JPY falling toward 153.00 (–0.5%) on BoJ rate-hike speculation.^[55] The 10-year Treasury yield rose 4bp to 4.84% (2-year +4bp to 4.43%; 30-year +4bp to 5.29%); official par yields were not posted in time, so these are secondary-market levels.^[57,58]

Commodities & FX levels

Instrument	Tue 8 Sept	Wed 9 Sept
WTI crude (\$/bbl)	approx. 93–95	approx. 95–97 ^[47,48]
Brent crude (\$/bbl)	approx. 98–99	briefly >100 ^[47,48]
Gold (\$/oz)	4,355.80	4,404.84 (+1.1%) ^[49]
Silver (\$/oz)	65.75	67.16 (+2.1%) ^[50]
Copper, Comex (\$/lb)	approx. 6.74	6.7743 (+0.52%) ^[51]
DXY	n/a — not confirmed	approx. 98.7–98.8 ^[54,55]
USD/CAD	1.3803	approx. 1.3785 ^[38,56]
EUR/USD	n/a — not confirmed	approx. 1.165 ^[55]
USD/JPY	n/a — not confirmed	approx. 153.00 (–0.5%) ^[55]
10-year UST yield	4.80%	4.84% (+4bp) ^[57,58]
2-year UST yield	4.39%	4.43% (+4bp) ^[57,58]
30-year UST yield	5.25%	5.29% (+4bp) ^[57,58]
SOFR	3.64%	not yet published ^[68]

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

VIX closed Wednesday at approx. 16.44–16.46 (+4.6–4.7%), up from 15.72; VVIX (+6.6% to 94.50) and VIX9D (+5.9% to 15.68) moved harder than the headline gauge, pointing to elevated near-dated hedging demand.^[59,60] VIX3M and VIX6M again served stale Tuesday-dated prints on Wednesday's check (18.39 flat, 20.34 +2.2%) — the CBOE thin-series staleness pattern flagged in prior editions recurring.^[59] The futures curve remains in contango (spot 16.46 < Sept 17.05 < Oct 18.62 < Dec 19.43 < Jan '27 20.30), consistent with the market pricing the CPI/FOMC/triple-witching cluster (11–18 Sept) as a discrete event rather than a regime shift.^[61]

Options markets price Oracle's Thursday print at an implied ±11.2% move — below its trailing four-quarter average of 16.1% — with a 2.3:1 call/put ratio;^[65] Apple's launch carried more modest 30-day IV (approx. 25–27%) with a bullish-leaning 1.1–1.7:1 call/put skew, consistent with product launches historically moving AAPL only 2–4%.^[63,64] CFTC CoT data remains as of Tuesday 1 Sept (S&P 500 non-commercials net short approx. 89,371 contracts); the next report, covering 8 Sept positioning, is due Friday 11 Sept.^[66,67] SOFR held steady at 3.64%, in a tight 3.58–3.73% band all week — no funding stress.^[68]

SPDR sector ETFs: selloff broadened and deepened Tue→Wed

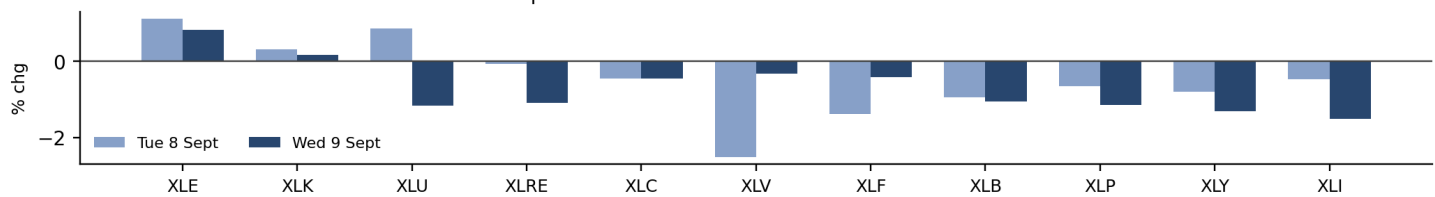


Chart 2 — SPDR sector ETF closes, Tue 8 vs Wed 9 Sept 2026.^[3,4]

6. The day ahead

Thursday 10 Sept: August PPI at 8:30am ET (single-sourced preview consensus: +0.4% m/m / +5.3% y/y headline, +0.3% m/m / +4.6% y/y core — flagged low-confidence pending a second source) and initial jobless claims (cons. approx. 205K);^[41] Oracle reports Q1 FY27 after the close (call 4pm CT), with options pricing an ±11.2% move.^[45,46] **Friday 11 Sept:** August CPI at 8:30am ET (multi-source consensus +0.4% m/m / +3.4% y/y headline, +0.2% m/m / +2.4% y/y core) — now seen as more decisive for the 16 Sept FOMC decision than early September's payrolls beat;^[42,43] University of Michigan preliminary September sentiment at 10am ET (prior: 51.7 final August; no consensus figure available).^[44] The FOMC blackout continues through 17 Sept; the rate decision lands Tuesday 16 Sept.

This week's known catalysts

Date	Event	Note
Thu 10 Sept	PPI (Aug)	+0.4% m/m headline (single-sourced estimate) ^[41]
Thu 10 Sept	Oracle Q1 FY27 earnings, after close	Options-implied move approx. ±11.2% ^[46]
Fri 11 Sept	CPI (Aug)	+0.4% m/m / +3.4% y/y headline (multi-source) ^[42,43]
Fri 11 Sept	UMich prelim Sept sentiment	Prior 51.7; no consensus available ^[44]
Tue 16 Sept	FOMC rate decision	Blackout since 5 Sept ^[30,31]
Fri 18 Sept	Quarterly triple witching	Large options expiry
Tue 29 Sept	US ban on Canadian alcohol/dairy/motorcycles	Trade-war escalation ^[36,37]

Sector setup we take into Thursday

- **Energy** is the only two-day sector winner; the Hormuz risk premium likely persists into Thursday/Friday absent de-escalation.
- **Healthcare** was the two-day laggard (Novartis trial failures, UnitedHealth's margin commentary) — watch for read-through to other managed-care and pharma names.
- **Mega-cap AI/tech is bifurcated:** Meta's agent launch was rewarded, Apple's hardware refresh was a shrug; Oracle's Thursday print is the next test of AI-capex sentiment, with a wide implied move already priced in.
- **Rates-sensitive small caps** underperformed both days (Russell −0.5%/−1.3%) as yields ticked up — exposed into Friday's CPI.

Annex A — Could not verify this edition

- Exact NYSE/Nasdaq advance-decline issue counts for either session (only qualitative/ETF-proxy breadth obtained).
- GME's exact after-hours move in the minutes following Tuesday's post-close print (only regular-session closes confirmed).
- Cleveland-Cliffs (CLF) closing price/% change for either 8 or 9 Sept.
- Formal sell-side price-target changes issued specifically in reaction to Apple's iPhone 18 event.
- A confirmed "Wednesday's top analyst calls" round-up (Tuesday's equivalent was found and used; Wednesday's could not be located).
- Official NYMEX/ICE settlement prints for oil and Comex settlement for copper on either day (market-snapshot/secondary sources used instead, disclosed inline).
- VIX3M and VIX6M fresh Wednesday closes — CBOE's feed again served stale Tuesday-dated prints for these two tenors.
- Official Treasury par yields for either session (secondary-market levels used instead).
- A populated consensus estimate for Friday's UMich preliminary September sentiment reading.
- The exact options-data vendor/methodology behind Oracle's 11.2% implied-move figure, and a single clean AAPL expected-move percentage (paywalled on the source checked).
- Dealer gamma/GEX levels for AAPL or ORCL; MOVE index; CBOE put/call ratio; official CME FedWatch probabilities (persistent, known-hard-to-source).
- A single authoritative Comex tape confirming copper's exact new record level and date (TASS and Yahoo Finance corroborate approx. \$6.85–6.87/lb, 8 Sept, but neither cites an exchange-certified settlement).

Annex B — Sources

1. AP, "How major US stock indexes fared Tuesday" (via WTOP), 8 Sept 2026	23. Benzinga, Casey's General Stores Q1 earnings, 8 Sept 2026	46. Trader Central, ORCL Q1 FY2027 earnings options preview, 8 Sept 2026
2. AP, "How major US stock indexes fared Wednesday" (via KRMG), 9 Sept 2026	24. Proactive Investors, "Casey's shares slide despite earnings beat", 9 Sept 2026	47. Forbes Advisor, "Oil Prices Today", 8–9 Sept 2026
3. Stockanalysis.com, SPDR sector ETF & equity history pages, 8–9 Sept 2026	25. TradingKey, Market Movers UNH, 9 Sept 2026	48. ABC News, "Oil prices climb toward \$100/barrel", 9 Sept 2026
4. Investing.com, XLK historical data, 9 Sept 2026	26. DailyTradeAlert, Analyst upgrades/downgrades, 8 Sept 2026	49. Trading Economics, Gold spot price, 8–9 Sept 2026
5. Investrade, Market Review, 8 Sept 2026	27. Yahoo Finance, "Tuesday's Top Wall Street Analyst Research Calls", 8 Sept 2026	50. Trading Economics, Silver spot price, 8–9 Sept 2026
6. Investrade, Market Review, 9 Sept 2026	28. Federal Reserve Board, Kevin Warsh biography, federalreserve.gov	51. Trading Economics, Copper (Comex), 8–9 Sept 2026
7. TheStreet, Stock Market Today live blog, 9 Sept 2026	29. Federal Reserve Board, Board Members roster, federalreserve.gov	52. TASS, "Copper futures reach all-time high", 8 Sept 2026
8. CNBC, Apple iPhone launch date / John Ternus, 26 Aug 2026	30. St. Louis Fed, FOMC blackout periods	53. Yahoo Finance, "Copper just soared to new records", 8 Sept 2026
9. Motley Fool, "Apple unveils iPhone Duo...", 9 Sept 2026	31. Federal Reserve Board, FOMC calendars	54. Trading Economics, US Dollar Index (DXY), 9 Sept 2026
10. Stockanalysis.com, AAPL history	32. CNBC, "Fed Governor Waller indicates support for holding rates steady", 3 Sept 2026	55. FXStreet, "Forex Today", 9 Sept 2026
11. Alain Guillot, Stock Market Recap, 9 Sept 2026	33. CNBC, "Canada retaliatory tariffs", 8 Sept 2026	56. Knightsbridge FX, Canadian Dollar Daily Update, 9 Sept 2026
12. Motley Fool, "Meta surges over 6.5% on Muse AI agent launch", 9 Sept 2026	34. Canada.ca, official counter-tariff product list, Dept. of Finance	57. Forbes Advisor, "Treasury Rates Today", 8 Sept 2026
13. TradingKey, Market Movers META, 9 Sept 2026	35. Blakes (law firm), Canada counter-tariffs summary, 8 Sept 2026	58. Trading Economics, US government bond yields (10Y/2Y/30Y), 9 Sept 2026
14. Benzinga, "Marvell calls itself the Switzerland of AI", 9 Sept 2026	36. NPR, "Canada escalating trade war with US", 8 Sept 2026	59. CBOE, delayed-quotes API (VIX/VIX9D/VIX3M/VIX6M/VVIX/SKEW), 9 Sept 2026
15. TradingKey, Market Movers MRVL, 9 Sept 2026	37. Fortune, "US-Canada trade war: alcohol, dairy, motorcycle ban", 9 Sept 2026	60. Vistaglobal, "Stock Market Today Sept 9, 2026" market-close recap
16. Stockanalysis.com, GME history	38. Vantage Markets, USD/CAD forecast, 8 Sept 2026	61. CBOE, futures settlement page, VIX term structure, 9 Sept 2026
17. 24/7 Wall St, "GameStop's earnings just changed the bull case", 9 Sept 2026	39. Al Jazeera, "US destroys five Iranian tankers, Iran retaliates", 9 Sept 2026	62. MacRumors, "KeyBanc: iPhone 18 event could hit Apple shares", 7 Sept 2026
18. Benzinga, GameStop Q2 earnings, 8 Sept 2026	40. DeepDraft SITREP, Hormuz tanker traffic, 8 Sept 2026	63. Options Trading Report, "Apple drops before Sept 9 event", 5 Sept 2026
19. TipRanks, GameStop Sept 8 earnings date, 8 Sept 2026	41. TradingKey, US August PPI outlook preview	64. Market Rebellion, Mid-Session IV Report, 8 Sept 2026
20. Yahoo Finance / 24/7 Wall St, "GameStop rises 4% as collectibles sales jump 57%", 9 Sept 2026	42. Kiplinger, "CPI report August 2026: what to expect", 9 Sept 2026	65. TipRanks / Trader Central, Oracle implied-move preview, 8 Sept 2026
21. Concurrences.com, EU General Court Booking/eTraveli ruling, Sept 2026	43. Nowflation, CPI August 2026 preview	66. CFTC, Commitments of Traders release schedule & Financial Futures report
22. StockStory, Booking Holdings, 9 Sept 2026	44. Investing.com, Michigan consumer sentiment economic calendar	67. Tradingster, CoT S&P 500 futures tracker
	45. Oracle Investor Relations, Q1 FY27 earnings date press release	68. SOFRrate.com, SOFR daily tracker (NY Fed data)

Method note: index closes use AP's wire report as the primary source, with the updated (not preliminary) Reuters/AP figures preferred where both are available. Where sources disagreed materially on a figure, both readings are disclosed inline or in the box above rather than silently resolved. Sector figures use same-day SPDR Select Sector ETF closes as a proxy for GICS sector performance (no closing 11-sector table is available same-day). Official settlement prints for oil, copper and Treasury par yields were not obtainable within the research window; secondary-market levels are used and flagged. This briefing is market-wide with no portfolio tilt or holdings commentary.